SKILLCONNECT

A Smart Local Marketplace for Skilled Service Professionals

1. Project Overview

SkillConnect is a mobile-based local service marketplace that connects customers with skilled professionals such as plumbers, electricians, carpenters, painters, cleaners, mechanics, AC technicians, computer technicians, web developers, app developers, graphic designers, and other service providers.

The main purpose of the platform is to make it easy for customers to find, compare, contact, request quotations from, and book reliable professionals in their preferred area. Unlike a simple service-booking application, SkillConnect is also designed as a **business-growth platform** for independent professionals by providing them with a complete digital business profile.

2. Problem Statement

Customers often find local professionals through personal references, Facebook groups, advertisements, nearby shops, or random phone calls. These methods make it difficult to compare professionals based on experience, ratings, availability, previous work, and location.

At the same time, many skilled professionals have difficulty reaching new customers and do not have an affordable digital platform for promoting their services in specific local areas. SkillConnect aims to solve both problems by creating a unified platform for: **Professional Discovery + Business Profile + Contact + Booking + Reviews + Promotion.**

3. How SkillConnect Works

Customer Flow

Login → Select Service → Select Area → Search Professionals → Compare Profiles → Call / Request Quote / Book → Service Completed → Rating & Review

Professional Flow

Register → Create Profile → Add Skills/Portfolio → Select Service Area → Set Availability → Receive Leads/Bookings → Complete Service → Build Reputation → Promote Profile

Admin Flow

Verify Professionals → Manage Users and Categories → Monitor Bookings → Moderate Reviews → Manage Promotions → Handle Reports

4. Main Features

Customer Features

- Service and area-based search
- Filters by rating & distance
- Professional profile viewing
- Direct call / contact
- Request for quotation
- Service booking & tracking
- Ratings and reviews

Professional Features

- Digital business profile
- Skills, experience & portfolio
- Service-area selection
- Availability management
- Booking accept/reject
- Promotion package purchase
- Basic business analytics

Admin Features

- User & category management
- Professional verification
- Review moderation
- Promotion-package control
- Pricing configuration
- System analytics & reports

5. Business Model

SkillConnect follows a Freemium Two-Sided Marketplace model. Customers can use the core discovery features for free, while professionals can create a basic profile for free. The primary revenue source is **area-based, time-bound profile promotion**.

Promotion Package	Duration	Price (Configurable)
Starter	1 Day	BDT 100
Weekly	7 Days	BDT 300
Half-Month	15 Days	BDT 500
Monthly	30 Days	BDT 800

Example of Area-Based Promotion: An electrician working in Mirpur can select: *Electrician + Mirpur + 7 Days = BDT 300*. The professional receives higher visibility in relevant Mirpur searches for seven days. After expiry, the profile automatically returns to normal ranking.

6. Competitive Difference

While Bangladesh has platforms covering parts of the service marketplace (like Sheba.xyz), SkillConnect differentiates itself through the combination of a professional business identity and hyperlocal customer acquisition:

- **Area-Based Paid Promotion:** Professionals choose the exact service category and geographic area where they want more visibility.
- **Flexible Promotion Duration:** Low-cost options starting from BDT 100/day fit any budget.
- **Professional-Owned Profiles:** Each profile functions as a mini business page containing bio, portfolio, reviews, and direct contact.
- **Physical & Digital Services:** Supports traditional local services (plumbing) and digital services (web development, IT support).
- **Quality-Aware Ranking:** Paid promotion increases visibility but considers factors like Rating, Distance, and Profile Quality to balance advertising with customer trust.

7. Core Business Advantage

SkillConnect creates a recurring business loop that generates value for both sides. **Customers** get convenience, transparency, and a local discovery system built on trust and reviews. **Professionals** can start for free, gather customer leads, build their reputation, and eventually utilize paid promotion to gain more visibility, which directly translates to more business.

8. Technology & Expected Outcome

The system will be developed using **Flutter**/**Dart** for the mobile frontend, **Python (Django**/**FastAPI)** for the backend, and **PostgreSQL** as the database. Authentication will be managed via JWT, notifications via Firebase Cloud Messaging, and mapping through Google Maps/OpenStreetMap.

The expected outcome is a fully functional marketplace where customers effortlessly find and book skilled professionals, while professionals build a digital identity and promote their services in targeted local areas.

SkillConnect — Find Skills. Connect Locally. Grow Your Business.